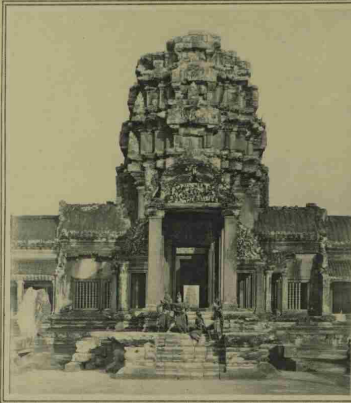


TRAINING FOR THE CAMBODIAN ROYAL CORPS DE BALLET

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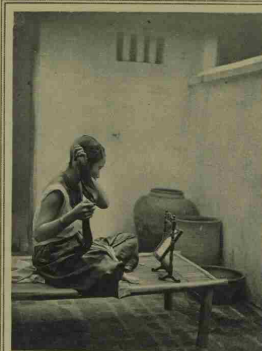
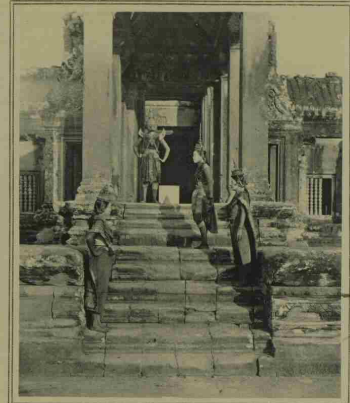
SHOWING A
VISTA OF
ANOTHER GREAT
TOWER SEEN
THROUGH THE
ENTRANCE
PASSAGE: THE
TEMPLE AT
ANGKOR, WITH
DANCERS POSED
ON THE STEPS.

WITH OLD WOMEN AS "DRESSES" AND GIRL ATTEND-
ANTS: DANCERS "MAKING UP" AT THE TEMPLE.WHERE PRIESTESSES ONCE DANCED: A CAMBODIAN GIRL
BEING "MADE UP" IN THE TEMPLE.IMITATING THE FIRST-CENTURY SCULPTURED DANCERS ON THE WALL BEHIND, OR UNCONSCIOUSLY FOLLOWING THE SAME TRADITION NEARLY 2000 YEARS OLD?
CAMBODIAN GIRL DANCERS MIMING IN THE ANCIENT TEMPLE OF ANGKOR.

On a later page in this number we give a translation of a French article, by M. V. Forbin, describing a visit to the great temple of Angkor Wat, in Cambodia, and the performance of some girls who had gone on pilgrimage to dance there as part of their training for the Cambodian royal corps de ballet. "By executing sacred dances on the threshold of the venerable temple," he writes, "which reminds the givers of the past splendours of their race, the little Cambodian dancers are convinced that they are fulfilling an act of piety, which will ensure them the protection of the good goddesses. . . . The troupe consisted of four dancers, two old women expert in the art of costume and make-up, and two little girls in charge of the accessories—diadems of gilded bronze, metal masks, heavy necklaces and pendants, and other objects. . . . They finished dressing and made themselves up on the actual threshold of the pagoda, in a little courtyard

AT A FAMOUS TEMPLE: PILGRIM DANCERS AT ANGKOR.

ECONOMIQUE DE L'INDO-CHINE.

PREPARING FOR THE PILGRIM DANCE AT THE TEMPLE
OF ANGKOR: ONE OF THE GIRLS DOING HER HAIR.WEARING THEIR
DIADEMS OF
GILDED BRONZE,
METAL MASKS,
NECKLACES AND
PENDANTS: GIRL
DANCERS
(INCLUDING A
"HERO" AND
A "DEMON")
ON THE STEPS OF
THE ANGKOR
TEMPLE.COME TO DANCE AT THE ANGKOR SHRINE AS AN ACT OF PIETY, TO OBTAIN THE FAVOUR OF THE GODDESSES AND REMIND THE PEOPLE OF THEIR SPLENDID PAST:
CAMBODIAN DANCING GIRLS AT THE FOOT OF THE TEMPLE STEPS.

where the priestesses of Angkor probably danced in far-off days. . . . I was impressed by some miming which the four dancers displayed before a bas-relief said to date from the first century, and representing dancers. I was struck by the similarity of pose between the living dancers and those portrayed in stone. Did they copy them, or were they merely following a tradition of nearly twenty centuries?" Angkor Wat has been called the Versailles of Cambodia, and a replica of its magnificent temple was built at Marseilles for the French Colonial Exhibition there last year. A photograph of Cambodian dancers in France miming before the Marseilles model was given in our issue of August 5, 1922, and in that of December 3, 1921, were photographs of the temple itself in Cambodia, with its wonderful Khmer sculptures, including an avenue of giant stone statues bearing the sacred serpent.